MARKET REPORT · SEWANG LIQUOR

SPECIAL · Halloween weekend, by district

2026.10.28 · 3 min

Saturday Halloween, 10/31

Finish before Friday: 4 things

The first Saturday Halloween since COVID. **First check whether your venue is inside** the 14 districts Seoul named on 10/22 (03), find your box in 02 and tick the 4 to-dos in 08. Also inside: what 25 venues have prepared.

Sat 10.31	+12%	14
Last Saturdays: 2020·2015	Oct Instagram 'Halloween' vs. beer	Seoul-managed districts (10/22)

01 · Calendar

Oct 31 is a Saturday, first since 2020

10.31 Sat

2020 was not normal trading because of COVID. This year Halloween lands on the weekend peak.

Sat 2015	Sat 2020 COVID	Thu 2024	Fri 2025	Sat 2026 now

How to read · Day of the week for Oct 31. Shaded years = Saturday Halloween.

0 of 3	Fri·Sat
Dept. store chains with Halloween promos (2025)	This year's two peak days · Sunday is wind-down

In one line Halloween left the retail shelf and moved to **venues and theme parks**. Finish prep before Friday.

Source: calendar (day of week for 10/31) / Aju Economic Daily 2025.10.19 (no Halloween promos at the 3 dept. store chains or hypermarkets; only CU convenience stores, online — no 2026 promo coverage as of 10/24) / Elle Korea 2025.10.27 · Segye Ilbo 2026.10.24 (theme-park Halloween). ※ Published two weeks after the last issue (10/14) because of the Wed 10/21 closure.

02 · Decision grid

Which box is my venue in?

Two axes: is your district **inside Seoul's 14**, and do you **admit guests at the door** or **seat them at tables**?

	Entry-type (tickets · bars · lounges)	Table-service (pocha · hof · izakaya · BBQ)
Inside the 14	① **Event + crowd control** — Add a cap, exit routes and ID checks	② **One free item for costume tables** — One fixed ID checker · no menu overhaul
Outside the 14	③ **Ticket one night, Fri or Sat** — Pick your big night and pre-sell	④ **Step-1 props + one free item** — Stock at a normal Saturday level

How to read · Inside: crowd control comes first. Outside: pick your date first. Same frame as the Chuseok grid (W35). To-dos in 08.

Source: Sewang AI Center survey of 25 venues (2026.10.18, addresses verified on KakaoMap) / Seoul Metropolitan Government 2026.10.22 (same 14 districts as 2025). No sales effect verified — read as differences in behavior only.

03 · Streets KakaoTalk quiz answer

The streets are managed: 14 districts

14 districts

Crowd-risk districts named in Seoul's Halloween special measures this year (10/23–11/1; intensive 10/30–11/1). Same 14 as last year; the 8 shaded are priority.

Itaewon · **Hongdae** · **Seongsu** · **Konkuk Univ. (Kondae)** · **Gangnam Stn.** · **Apgujeong** · **Myeong-dong** · **Ikseon-dong** · Wangsimni · Sinchon · Balsan · Sillim · Sharosu-gil · Nonhyeon

How to read · Inside the 14, station-exit and traffic controls and subway skip-stops may apply (the announcement centers on Itaewon, Hongdae, Seongsu and Kondae). Confirmed this year — **Itaewon-ro fully closed to vehicles on 10/31** (flexible controls 10/23·24·30), one lane of Hongdae's club street turned over to pedestrians, possible exit controls and skip-stops at Itaewon, Hongik Univ., Seongsu and Konkuk Univ. stations. Customer access and delivery vehicles may be blocked.

110,000
Hongdae peak crowd (2025, both Sat 10/25 and Fri 10/31)

3,271
Total safety staff announced by Seoul (2026 · Itaewon 1,620)

Risk Tokyo's Shibuya ward, also facing a Saturday Halloween, banned street drinking and **asked nearby shops to refrain from selling alcohol**. Check local government notices on 10/31.

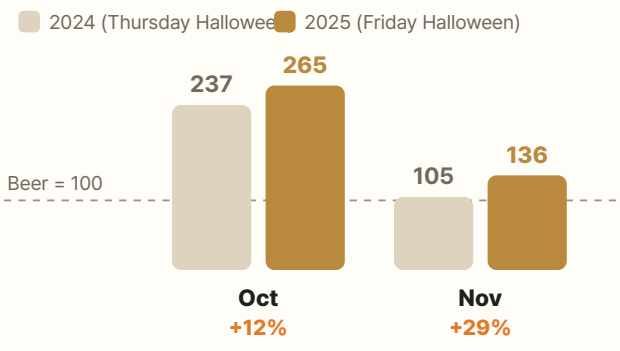
Source: Seoul Metropolitan Government announcement 2026.10.22 (Kyunghyang Shinmun · Money Today) / Seoul Shinmun 2025.10.27 (about 110,000 in Hongdae on 10/25) · Segye Ilbo 2025.11.1 (around 110,000 in Hongdae on 10/31) / Korea Economic TV 2026.10.2 (Shibuya). Crowd figures cover whole districts, not any one venue's sales.

04 · SNS

Instagram 'Halloween' posts run into November

+29%

November 'Halloween' posts vs. beer · 2025 vs 2024. October: +12%.



How to read · Instagram 'Halloween' posts ÷ beer posts ×100. Collection volume varies by year, so we use a ratio. Halloween fell on Thursday in 2024, Friday in 2025.

23% → 30%
November share of posts (of Oct+Nov)

+12%
October vs. beer (237 → 265)

Point Halloween carried into November (reviews may lag; not necessarily a weekday effect). **This year it's Saturday: the peak is two days, Fri–Sat.**

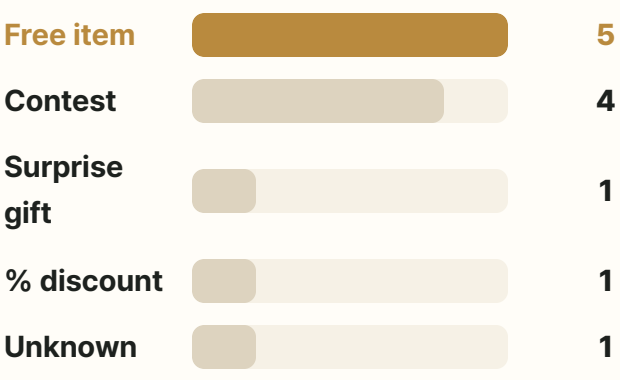
Source: Sometrend Instagram monthly mentions 2024.9–2025.11, collected 2026.10.18 and re-collected 10.24 (2025 figures unchanged). October absolute count +48% (beer +33%). Beer collection volume dropped sharply in Oct–Nov 2024, so allow ±10 pp. Sep–Oct 2026 excluded: collection still incomplete at the 10/24 re-pull.

05 · 25 venues

Costume-table perks: 12 of 25 venues

12/25 venues

offered a perk to tables of costumed guests. The perks were —



How to read · Based on Oct 2025 posts and blogs (incl. 2023–24 and 2026 announcements). Free item = a shot, a main dish, a bottle of soju, a side or stickers. Sales effect unverified.

3/25
Limited menus/packages (2 all-you-can-drink · 1 limited dish/wine)

4 venues
Full-theme decor 4 · photo zone/props 3 (other 18 unverified)

Point **Not one of the 25 bars was confirmed to have created a new Halloween-only drink.** Small table venues go for a free item; ticketed and all-you-can-drink venues go for discounts and packages.

Source: Sewang AI Center venue survey (2026.10.18) — full text of 5 Naver blog posts + Instagram/Threads/Karrot search summaries + 25 addresses verified on KakaoMap (8 inside the 14 · 4 in Seoul outside the 14 · 13 in southern Gyeonggi). No phone or on-site verification.

06 · Menu · Decor

Change one drink's color, add one photo spot

One item
A dish, a shot or soju

Color only
One highball: glass & color

One photo zone
The entrance is enough

1 **Props**
Face stickers · one pumpkin — Suwon bar 2024, Gaebong izakaya 2025 (sponsored review)

2 **Swap the entrance photo zone ← stop here**
A Halloween version of your usual photo spot — Suwon hof pub 2025 (this one went all the way to step 3)

3 **Full theme**
Original theme, two years running — Itaewon lounge 2025. Highest cost and staffing

How to read · Three steps in order of investment. The smallest investment that gets guest photos is step 2 — one photo zone at the entrance.

Caution Anime-character themes (3 in Suwon, 1 address unverified) put **trademark and image liability on the venue** — this report does not recommend them. Get consent before posting guest photos; staff costumes are at the venue's expense.

Source: Sewang AI Center venue survey (2026.10.18) — Naver blog posts of 2025.10.24, 10.27, 10.29, 11.3 and 2024.11.4, Instagram/Threads search summaries. Venues are given as 'district + type' only, no names. Prices and quantities in 2026 announcements omitted as they may change.

07 · Operations

Two days, Fri–Sat, and the Saturday trap

Fri 10/30
Costumed guests from the evening. Orders and supplies done before this day. Seoul's intensive management starts (flexible controls on Itaewon-ro).

Sat 10/31 Halloween
Early open to late close. One fixed ID checker. Itaewon-ro fully closed to vehicles.

Sun 11/1
Wind-down. Mon 11/2 is a workday — not a peak.

How to read · The 7 venues with 2026 announcements split: Saturday only 2 · Fri–Sat 2 · a week or longer 2 · unverified 1. One venue's pre-bookings closed a week ahead (2024).

a **If Saturday is already your busiest night**
The Halloween lift may be smaller than on a weekday. Watch table turnover

b **Sunday is not a peak**
Extend hours only after costing labor

c **Traffic controls inside the 14**
Itaewon-ro fully closed on 10/31. Deliveries and access limited — check the day's scope

d **Last outdoor-seating weekend**
Overlaps the end of terrace season (W37). Weather is a variable

Source: Sewang AI Center venue survey (2026.10.18) — Instagram search summaries of 7 venues with 2026 announcements, Naver blog 2024.11.4 / Seoul Metropolitan Government 2026.10.22 / Market Report W37.

08 · This week

Tap to check off

- [ ] **Find your box — inside/outside the 14 × entry/table**
  Inside: crowd control first. Outside: pick your big night, Fri or Sat

- [ ] **Make the perk one free item**
  One main dish, one shot or one bottle of soju · no % discount you haven't costed

- [ ] **One fixed ID checker at the door**
  No exceptions for costumes · entry-type: cap, exit routes, keep-right guidance

- [ ] **Orders & supplies before Friday**
  Ice, mixers and glassware at a normal Saturday level · no menu overhaul, no street tables

ORDER MEMO · before Fri 10/30

Last delivery date _____ (confirm with your sales rep)

Inside the 14: ask your sales rep about 10/31 traffic controls and whether delivery is possible (Itaewon-ro is confirmed fully closed)

How to read · Four to-dos common to all four boxes. Your box (02) decides whether 'crowd control' or 'pick a night' comes first.

Source: decision grid in 02 / Ministry of the Interior and Safety 2026.10.20 (special safety management 10/23–11/1, 28 districts nationwide, 'Caution' alert level — check exits in advance, keep safe distances, evacuate quickly) / Seoul Economic Daily 2025.10.29 (keep-right one-way flow). For draft beer certification and orders, ask your sales rep.

09 · Calendar · Next issue

Last week of October

Wed 10/28	**This issue published** First in two weeks after the 10/21 closure
Fri 10/30	**Orders & supplies deadline** Seoul intensive management starts · confirm last delivery date with your sales rep
Sat 10/31	**Halloween** Itaewon-ro fully closed · inside the 14, check traffic controls
Wed 11/4	**Next issue** Topic in preparation

How to read · Orders before Friday; on the day, ID checks and traffic controls. For Halloween-day orders and deliveries, ask your sales rep.

Share

Send to owners in your district

Neighboring venues need the Halloween traffic-control and delivery info too — all the more inside the 14. Just send the owner next door this one link.

Send the link to the owner next door

☕ Share to enter automatically · weekly coffee voucher draw (valid when someone opens your link · winners leave a phone number in the next issue)

Next issue · Wed, Nov 4

Published Wed, Nov 4 — topic in preparation

Add our Kakao channel — next issue by KakaoTalk

Your sales reps (12 + CEO) −

Lee Han-woo EVP
Head of Sales · 010-5210-5449 — Call

Park Jeong-eon Exec. Dir.
Yeoksam·Nonhyeon·Sinsa·Cheongdam·Daechi·Samseong / Seocho·Bangbae / Gwanak·Dongjak · 010-3286-9489 — Call

Son Seung-il Managing Dir.
Franchise · 010-7539-3535 — Call

Lee Won-cheol Director
Gangbuk·Jongno·Jung-gu / Dongdaemun·Jungnang·Nowon·Dobong / Seongdong·Gwangjin · 010-3354-2101 — Call

Chae Hyeon-yong Director
Hotels · Wine · 010-8889-3057 — Call

Kim Hwan Director
Incheon / Bucheon·Siheung·Ansan · 010-4789-3282 — Call

Oh Geon-hoon Director
Songpa·Gangdong·Jamsil / Japanese liquor · 010-3495-6515 — Call

Shin Hong-cheol Director
Bundang·Pangyo·Gwanggyo / Suwon·Yongin·Anyang · 010-9259-6474 — Call

Bae Jong-hwan GM
Gangseo·Yangcheon·Guro·Geumcheon·Yeongdeungpo / Goyang·Paju·Gimpo · 010-9209-6526 — Call

Yoo Gwang-seok GM
Hanam·Misa·Guri·Namyangju·Uijeongbu · 010-4565-6039 — Call

Seong Hyeon-woo GM

Yongsan·Itaewon·Hannam / Mapo·Seodaemun·Eunpyeong · 010-3375-3646

Call

Hwang Hyeon-woong Deputy GM

New accounts · 010-9123-4341

Call

Jung Min-sung CEO

Sewang Trading Co., Ltd. · 010-3964-9290

Call

Sources (13) −

01 Seoul Metropolitan Government announcement 2026.10.22 (Kyunghyang Shinmun · Money Today, 10.22) — special measures 10/23–11/1, intensive 10/30–11/1; 14 districts (10 gu), 8 priority; Itaewon-ro fully closed 10/31 (flexible 10/23·24·30); one lane of Hongdae club street; exit controls and skip-stops at major stations; 3,271 safety staff (Itaewon 1,620 · Hongdae 326 · Ikseon-dong 312 · Gangnam Stn. 204); 361 AI CCTVs

02 Seoul Media Hub 2025.10.24 — 2025: 14 districts, 8 priority (same as this year), period 10/24–11/2

03 Seoul Shinmun 2025.10.27 — Sat 10/25 Hongdae peak about 110,000 (Mapo-gu), 4,922 police on special duty / Segye Ilbo 2025.11.1 — Fri 10/31, 21:00–23:00, Hongdae around 110,000, Itaewon 18,000

04 Ministry of the Interior and Safety 2026.10.20 inter-agency meeting (KDI policy archive) — special safety management 10/23–11/1, 28 districts nationwide under intensive management, 'Caution' alert level, on-site situation managers in 12 key areas / Seoul Economic Daily 2025.10.29 — 2025 guidance (exits, evacuation routes, keep-right one-way flow)

05 Aju Economic Daily 2025.10.19 — no Halloween promos at the 3 dept. store chains or hypermarkets; only CU convenience stores, online (no 2026 promo coverage as of 10/24)

06 Korea Economic TV 2026.10.2 — Shibuya ward street-drinking ban and request that shops refrain from selling alcohol

07 ET News 2025.10.30 — Google's top 5 Halloween costume searches of 2025 (used in the PDF edition)

08 Elle Korea 2025.10.10 · 10.27 — café and theme-park limited menus (non-alcohol reference, used in the PDF edition)

09 Sometrend Instagram monthly mentions — 'Halloween' (two Korean spellings + English) / beer, collected 2024.9–2026.10 (period used: 2024.9–2025.11; 2026 excluded as incomplete), collected 2026.10.18, re-collected 10.24

10 Field data · survey of 25 venues — full text of 5 blog posts, Instagram/Threads/Karrot search summaries (Facebook-sourced venues excluded from the main table, addresses unverified), addresses verified on KakaoMap. No phone or on-site verification

11 Calendar — day of week for 10/31 (Sat in 2015·2020·2026, Thu 2024, Fri 2025)

12 Market Report W35 (Chuseok decision grid) · W37 (outdoor-seating season)

13 Segye Ilbo 2026.10.24 — Seoul Land combined Halloween/Christmas decor (theme-park reference)

※ Venues are given as 'district + type' only, no names. Cases reflect notices as posted; actual execution and results were not verified. 'Field data' is not official statistics.

All past issues — Report Center

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